بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

JAMHIYATU ANSAARUD-DÎN

جمعية أنصار الدين

MOROCCO CHAPTER

CONCEPT NOTE

# International colloquium on Sufism, *peace* and the dialogue of civilisations

**6 · 7 · 8 NOVEMBER 2026**

CASABLANCA — KINGDOM OF MOROCCO

*"Spiritual diplomacy and bilateral relations: the role of States and of religious and local leaders in strengthening ties between Morocco and Senegal"*

SECOND EDITION · CONTACT@ANSAAR-MA.COM

CONCEPT NOTE

*From 6 to 8 November 2026, Jamhiyatou Ansaarud-Dîn – Morocco Chapter brings together in Casablanca researchers, scholars, spiritual guides, institutional leaders and local leaders around one question: how can spiritual diplomacy strengthen ties between Morocco and Senegal and serve peace?*

| | |
|---|---|
| TITLE | International colloquium on Sufism, peace and the dialogue of civilisations |
| CENTRAL THEME | “Spiritual diplomacy and bilateral relations: the role of States and of religious and local leaders in strengthening ties between Morocco and Senegal” |
| DATES | Friday 6, Saturday 7 and Sunday 8 November 2026 |
| VENUES | Cultural Centre, Sidi Maarouf (Friday); Cristalia reception hall, Sidi Maarouf (Saturday and Sunday) – Casablanca |
| ORGANISER | Jamhiyatou Ansaarud-Dîn – Morocco Chapter |
| FORMAT | 2 panels, 8 themes, opening and closing ceremonies, documentary exhibition, Arabic–French simultaneous interpretation |
| CONTACT | contact@ansaar-ma.com · +221 77 207 80 39 / +212 631-331784 |

## 01 Background and rationale

On 8 November 2025, Jamhiyatou Ansaarud-Dîn – Morocco Chapter held a day in Casablanca (Saadallah hall, Aïn Sebaa) devoted to the memory and thought of Cheikh Al-Islam El Hadj Ibrahima Niass (1900–1975), known as Baye Niass, founder of the Fayda Tijaniyya. It brought together spiritual guides, scholars, diaspora delegations (Spain, England, Italy, France, Belgium, Nigeria, Côte d’Ivoire, Mauritania) and official representatives, including the Consul General of Senegal in Casablanca. It also included the public reading of a letter from the General Caliph of the Fayda, Cheikh Mouhammadoul Mahi Ibrahim Niass, addressed to the Chapter.

That edition revealed three things:

I **A demand for meeting spaces** between the spiritual families of Morocco and West Africa. Speakers showed the links between the Tariqa Bassiriya (Darqawiyya) of Morocco and the Tijaniyya, and recalled the role of Abdellah Ben Yassin in the Islamisation of Senegal.

II **A call for unity.** The President of the national Jamhiyatou Ansaarud-Dîn of Senegal, Serigne Seydina Alioune Cissé Niang, stressed collaboration between all federations and chapters around the world.

III **A fruitful thesis.** In the words of Serigne Alioune Niang, the work of Baye Niass offers "a powerful model of dialogue between peoples, founded on spirituality and humanism rather than on politics or force". This thesis deserves scholarly study.

The 2025 edition coincided with the fiftieth anniversary of the Green March. The Chapter's President, Cheikh Ibrahima Diop, recalled the delegation sent by Baye Niass in 1975 to show his support for Morocco. This episode confirms that Moroccan–Senegalese relations rest on a shared history, which the 2025 documentary exhibition began to bring to light, notably through a photograph of Baye Niass at the 1974 Hassaniya Lectures, published in Morocco for the first time.

The 2026 colloquium continues this work. It moves from a commemorative day to a three-day international colloquium structured in academic panels, and broadens the focus from the figure of Baye Niass to the relationship between two nations, to spiritual diplomacy and to the role of the territories that are its living setting.

## 02 Problem statement

Morocco and Senegal have shared scholarly, diplomatic and spiritual ties for centuries. These ties begin with the arrival of the Sufi paths in Senegal, then the spread of the Qadiriyya (Hadariya), and later of the Tijaniyya, alongside other tariqas present in both countries: the Mouridiyya in Senegal, the Chadhiliyya and the Darqawiyya (including the Bassiriyya) in Morocco. They continue through the training of Senegalese scholars in Morocco and of Moroccan scholars in Dakar, and through meetings between scholars and heads of State, including some landmark moments:

- the historic address delivered in **1964** by El Hadj Abdoul Aziz Sy Dabakh at the inauguration of the Great Mosque of Dakar by His Majesty King Hassan II, alongside his counterpart, Senegalese President Léopold Sédar Senghor;

- the participation of Cheikh Ibrahim Niass in the 1,100th anniversary celebrations of Al Quaraouiyine University in Fez, where he gave an address, and his award of the Order of the Throne in **1966** by His Majesty King Hassan II;
- his presence at the **Hassaniya Lectures**;
- the addresses of His Majesty King Mohammed VI in Dakar in **2015**, marking the anniversary of the Green March.

Yet these ties have rarely been studied together, and seldom considered as a form of diplomacy, or in their territorial dimension: the holy cities, regions and local authorities where these relations are lived and passed on every day.

> CENTRAL QUESTION
>
> To what extent can States, religious leaders and local leaders, drawing on Sufism and its networks, strengthen ties between Morocco and Senegal and contribute to peace and the dialogue of civilisations?

It breaks down into five questions:

1. What historical, scholarly and spiritual ties unite the two countries, since the arrival and spread of the tariqas, and through which figures and institutions have they been passed on?
2. How do the diplomacy of States and that of religious guides complement each other, and what is the specific role of the zawiyas?
3. What role do local leaders (presidents of regions, mayors, elected officials) and territories (holy cities, regions, local authorities) play in consolidating relations between Morocco and Senegal, notably through decentralised cooperation?
4. What can Sufism, as spiritual "soft power", contribute to conflict prevention, reconciliation and the safeguarding of intangible heritage?
5. What joint initiatives (academic, cultural, territorial, intergenerational, South–South) can carry this rapprochement forward?

> WORKING HYPOTHESIS
>
> *Sufi spirituality is a common language and a lasting network. It complements the action of States and the roots of territories: together, these three levers give Moroccan–Senegalese rapprochement its full depth and durability.*

## 03 Objectives

**GENERAL OBJECTIVE**

To make Casablanca, from 6 to 8 November 2026, a place of scholarly reflection and spiritual encounter on the role of spiritual diplomacy in bringing Morocco and Senegal closer together.

**SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES**

1. Document and showcase the shared history of the two countries, from 1910 to the present day, through a timeline and a documentary exhibition, from the arrival of the tariqas to contemporary relations, including the addresses of 1964 and 2015.
2. Highlight the figures who carried this rapprochement: the family of Cheikh Omar Foutiyou Tall; the family of Cheikh El Hadj Malick Sy, in particular through Cheikh Abdou Aziz Sy Dabakh; the family of Cheikh Abdoulaye Niass, notably through Cheikh Ibrahima Niass; as well as contemporary scholars and actors, including Serigne Abass Sall of Louga.
3. Analyse the complementary roles of States, religious leaders, zawiyas and local leaders in diplomatic relations, religious diplomacy and mediation.
4. Showcase the territories (regions, holy cities, local authorities) that drive the consolidation of relations between Morocco and Senegal, and encourage partnerships between their leaders.
5. Pay tribute to distinguished figures: Khalife Seydi Ali Al Hassan Cissé, Cheikh Mouhamad Al Makki Ibrahim Niass and Sayyida Rokhaya bint Cheikh Ibrahim Niass.
6. Make Africa's voice heard in international bodies and open prospects for South–South partnerships.
7. Involve young people in projects for peace and dialogue between civilisations.
8. Adopt final recommendations and a roadmap for spiritual, cultural, scholarly and territorial cooperation.

## 04 Themes

The proceedings are organised in two panels and eight themes. The first panel (Saturday) examines the history of relations between the two States and the diplomatic, scholarly and spiritual ties that unite them; the second (Sunday) draws lessons from them for diplomacy and peace.

PANEL 1 · SATURDAY 7 NOVEMBER

**Morocco and Senegal: a history of relations between States and of diplomatic, scholarly and spiritual ties**

| Theme | Title | Issues |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Scholars, Shuyukh and the figures of rapprochement** | Role of scholars and religious leaders in building bridges; arrival and spread of the Qadiriyya (Hadariya), then of the Tijaniyya, and role of the other tariqas of Senegal (Mouridiyya) and Morocco (Chadhiliyya, Darqawiyya); shared spiritual memory carried by the family of Cheikh Omar Foutiyou Tall, the family of Cheikh El Hadj Malick Sy (in particular through Cheikh Abdou Aziz Sy Dabakh) and the family of Cheikh Abdoulaye Niass (notably through Cheikh Ibrahima Niass); Serigne Abass Sall of Louga and his ties with Morocco, which helped bring the two countries closer |
| 2 | **Cheikh Ibrahim Niass and Morocco** | Ties with the Kingdom; participation in the 1,100th anniversary of Al Quaraouiyine University in Fez and the address given on that occasion; award of the Order of the Throne in 1966 by His Majesty King Hassan II; contributions to the Hassaniya Lectures; influence across the Islamic world; spread of the Tijaniyya |
| 3 | **Moroccan–Senegalese diplomatic and bilateral relations: the role of States** | History of relations between States and institutional frameworks; historic address by El Hadj Abdoul Aziz Sy Dabakh (1964) at the inauguration of the Great Mosque of Dakar by His Majesty King Hassan II, alongside his counterpart, Senegalese President Léopold Sédar Senghor; address by His Majesty King Mohammed VI in Dakar (2015) marking the anniversary of the Green March; political, diplomatic, cultural and economic cooperation; strategic role of States and territories |
| 4 | **Spiritual and scholarly centres of Senegal** | Historic and contemporary interactions; contributions of scholars (Oustaz Barham Diop, Cheikh Mamoun Mbacké, Dr Ousmane Kane, among others); transmission of sciences and teaching methods; contribution of Oustaz Ibrahima Mahmoud Diop; territorial roots of the spiritual centres (Tivaouane, Médina Baye in Kaolack, Louga, Touba) and role of local authorities |

| Theme | Title | Issues |
|---|---|---|
| 5 | **Scholarly exchange and transmission of knowledge** | Paths of students and scholars trained in Morocco and Senegal; spread of Islamic knowledge; role of educational institutions |

PANEL 2 · SUNDAY 8 NOVEMBER

## Spiritual diplomacy for peace and international cooperation

| Theme | Title | Issues |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Role of Sufi figures, Senegalese zawiyas and local leaders in international religious diplomacy** | Reconciliation between people; spiritual soft power and conflict prevention; local leaders as relays for mediation and proximity; intangible cultural and spiritual heritage; Africa's voice in international bodies |
| 2 | **International focus on Cheikh Ibrahim Niass** | Global impact; spread of the Tijaniyya and bridges between peoples; scholarly and intellectual output; pioneering role in cultural and spiritual diplomacy |
| 3 | **Outlook and roadmap** | Cooperation roadmap; decentralised cooperation between regions, cities and local authorities of Morocco and Senegal; youth, peace and the dialogue of civilisations; academic cooperation; South–South partnerships |

## 05 Schedule, audience and methodology

| | |
|---|---|
| FRIDAY 6 NOVEMBER | CULTURAL CENTRE, SIDI MAAROUF<br>**Preliminary session (4:30 – 10:30 pm):** Hayllala and Dhikr after the Asr prayer, welcome of the Shuyukh, scholars and delegations; gatherings of exhortation and guidance in the evening. |
| SATURDAY 7 NOVEMBER | CRISTALIA RECEPTION HALL, SIDI MAAROUF<br>**Official opening ceremony (3:00 – 4:00 pm)** followed by **Panel 1 (4:00 – 9:00 pm)**. |
| SUNDAY 8 NOVEMBER | CRISTALIA RECEPTION HALL, SIDI MAAROUF<br>**Panel 2 (9:00 – 11:30 am)**, **official closing ceremony (11:30 am – 1:00 pm)**, close of the colloquium and fraternal lunch (1:00 pm). |

**Audience.** Scholars and Shuyukh, researchers and academics, representatives of official, diplomatic and religious authorities and institutions, local leaders and elected officials (regions, cities, local authorities), delegations from the federations of Jamhiyatou Ansaarud-Dîn of Senegal and the diaspora, young students and civil society actors.

**Methodology.** Each panel is placed under academic chairmanship. Papers address the themes above; they are punctuated by short sequences of Dhikr and Madih reflecting the diversity of participants and the unity of their spiritual and cultural heritage. Arabic–French simultaneous interpretation is provided. The documentary exhibition, with its timeline from 1910 to the present day, accompanies the proceedings, and a memorial space is dedicated to Sayyida Rokhaya bint Cheikh Ibrahim Niass.

**Working languages.** Arabic and French.

## 06 Expected outcomes and follow-up

- **Final recommendations**, read and adopted at the closing ceremony.
- A **roadmap** for spiritual, cultural and scholarly cooperation between Morocco and Senegal, with a youth component, an academic component and a territorial component.
- Avenues for **partnership between regions, cities and local authorities** of Morocco and Senegal, led by their leaders.

- A better knowledge of the shared history, thanks to the timeline from 1910 to the present day and the documentary exhibition.
- **Tributes** paid to distinguished figures, with the presentation of certificates of honour.
- A **network** of researchers, scholars and partners ready to carry this work forward.

The proceedings of the colloquium (papers and recommendations) could be published in Arabic and French. This publication is a possible follow-up, to be confirmed with the organising committee.

## 07 Organisation

The colloquium is organised by Jamhiyatou Ansaarud-Dîn – Morocco Chapter (Casablanca), chaired by Cheikh Ibrahima Diop.

CONTACT

**Jamhiyatu Ansaarud-Dîn**
Kingdom of Morocco
contact@ansaar-ma.com
+221 77 207 80 39 / +212 631-331784
Route 1029 Imm 96, Appt 4,
Sidi Maarouf, Casablanca, Morocco